



Term Paper

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Optimizing the Role of Facebook in B2C Customer Relationship Management

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Table Of Contents

Serial No.	Content Type	Page No.
1	Introduction (X)	1
2	Rationale of the topic (X)	2
3	Methodology (X)	3
5	Finding from Articles (Z)	4
6	Finding from Businessman-based Opinion (Z)	5
7	Reflection of the Authors (Y)	6
8	Conclusion (Y)	6
9	References (Y)	7
10	Appendix	7

Introduction

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B2C stands for Business to Customer. This refers to businesses that directly sell products or services to customers. One of the most important parts of any business is its customers, as they play a key role in its success. How well a business manages its relationships with customers often determines how successful it will be. Customer management means how businesses communicate with and support their customers. In the past, it was not easy to stay in touch with every customer individually. Following up with them took a lot of time and effort. But things have changed with the rise of social media, especially Facebook. Facebook has made customer management much simpler and more efficient. Businesses can now create Facebook pages to connect with their customers regularly. They can share updates, answer questions, and solve problems quickly. Customers, on the other hand, can easily reach out to businesses to share their feedback or raise any issues. The features offered by Facebook, such as instant messaging and comment sections, make communication between businesses and customers easier and faster. This benefits both sides, helping businesses build stronger relationships and making customers feel valued. This is why Facebook plays an important role in managing customer relationships in today's world of B2C businesses. (mention word limit after each section)

Rationale of the topic (X)

As students of the BBA department, the topic of Facebook's role in customer relationship management holds significant relevance to us. Understanding modern business practices, especially in the context of online platforms, is crucial for our academic and professional development. This subject not only aligns with our studies but also provides valuable insights into how businesses connect with their customers in today's digital age. In the current era, where most businesses operate online, adapting to platforms like Facebook is essential for survival and growth. Businesses that fail to utilize Facebook for customer engagement and relationship management often struggle to keep up with competitors. This makes the study of Facebook's impact on business practices highly relevant and timely, emphasizing its importance in maintaining a competitive edge in the modern business landscape.

Methodology

(X)

This study is designed to understand how Facebook helps improve Business-to-Customer (B2C) customer relationship management, focusing on businesses in Bangladesh.

Tools:

A set of structured questions will be used to collect data. It will have seven simple questions to understand how business owners use Facebook for managing customer relationships and how it compares to traditional methods. (If you use online video calling platforms such as zoom, google meet - mention their names)

Sampling Method:

A purposive sampling method will be used to choose 7 businessmen. There will be 6 questions in the Google Form. The group will include both traditional business owners and those who use Facebook and other online tools for customer management. This ensures views from both types of businesses are considered.

Findings from Articles (Z)

Social media has revolutionized Customer Relationship Management (CRM), providing businesses with new ways to connect and engage with customers. Among these platforms, Facebook has emerged as a key tool in the B2C context. Research shows that Facebook's features, such as Pages, Groups, and Messenger, enable businesses to interact with customers in real time, fostering trust and loyalty (Kaplan & Haenlein, 2010). Additionally, its targeted advertising capabilities and analytics tools help businesses reach specific audiences and gather actionable insights to refine their strategies (Tuten & Solomon, 2017). Compared to traditional methods, Facebook offers a cost-effective way to promote products, manage customer relationships, and enhance engagement. Businesses can use Pages to share updates, respond to customer inquiries, and collect feedback, while Messenger provides a private channel for addressing concerns promptly (Goh et al., 2013). However, challenges such as changes in algorithms, maintaining consistent engagement, and managing negative feedback can limit its effectiveness (De Vries et al., 2012). Emerging trends, such as the integration of AI-driven chatbots, have enhanced Facebook's CRM capabilities, allowing businesses to automate responses and provide instant support.

Findings from Businessman-based Opinion

(Z)

Online entrepreneurs often rely on Facebook for connecting with customers, driving sales, and managing relationships. They find the platform to be highly effective for business growth and customer interaction. However, they encounter challenges in targeting the right audience and maintaining consistent engagement. Many also seek more advanced tools and features to enhance their experience and maximize the potential of Facebook for their business. Traditional business owners often don't see Facebook as a valuable tool for their operations. They prefer relying on face-to-face interactions, word-of-mouth, and local advertising. Transitioning to online business models isn't a priority for them, and they don't view Facebook as crucial for growth. While they might occasionally use it for promotions, it is not a main focus. They are less concerned with engaging customers or managing feedback online, as they believe traditional, offline methods work better for their business.

Reflection of the Authors

(Y)

For online entrepreneurs, Facebook is a powerful tool for engaging with customers, increasing sales, and managing relationships. It has great potential for business growth, but they often face challenges with targeting the right audience and maintaining consistent engagement. This leads them to seek out better tools to optimize their use of Facebook and improve their business results. In contrast, traditional business owners do not consider Facebook essential. They rely more on face-to-face interactions, word-of-mouth, and local advertising, which have worked well for them in the past. Adopting online business models and using Facebook for growth is not a priority. While they may occasionally use Facebook for promotions, it is not central to their marketing strategy, as they believe traditional methods are more effective for their business.

Conclusion

(Y)

This paper, due to time and resource constraints, does not include extensive research or detailed case studies. However, it highlights an important issue: many small businesses have not embraced digital platforms like Facebook, often due to limited resources or lack of awareness. Despite the vast audience available, these businesses miss out on the opportunities Facebook offers. This study demonstrates how Facebook can help small businesses with customer

engagement, growth, and long-term success. The goal is to encourage business owners to adopt digital strategies and tap into the potential of the online market for better competitiveness.

References: (use 2 sources only)

(Y)

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2. Goh, K. Y., Heng, C. S., & Lin, Z. (2013). Social media brand community and consumer behavior: Quantifying the relative impact of user- and marketer-generated content. *Information Systems Research*, 24(1), 88-107.
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4. De Vries, L., Gensler, S., & Leeftang, P. S. H. (2012). Popularity of brand posts on brand fan pages: An investigation of the effects of social media marketing. *Journal of Interactive Marketing*, 26(2), 83-91.

Appendix:

Google Drive Link:

<https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1mQSbh7LI5hFM3dbwfQMIWjBysuJJfo6X?usp=sharing>